

And then there is the matter of demonstrated antiquity. The crucial point here is the lack of pattern; without pattern there is no dependency. I invite attention to the following four paragraphs, that make up a single quote, reproduced from “Early Uncial Support for $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ in the General Epistles”.

Each of these twelve uncials is plainly independent of all the others. The total lack of pattern in the attestation that these early uncials give to $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ shows just as plainly that $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ is independent of them all as well, quite apart from the 22.1% without them. But that 77.9% of the units receive early uncial support, without pattern or dependency, shows that the $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ text is early.

I invite special attention to the first block, where a single uncial sides with $\mathbf{f}^{35}$; each of the seven uncials is independent of the rest (and of $\mathbf{f}^{35}$) at this point, of necessity, yet together they attest 15% of the total ($119 \div 795$). Since there is no pattern or dependency for this 15%, how shall we account for these 119 early readings in $\mathbf{f}^{35}$? Will anyone argue that whoever ‘concocted’ the first $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ MS had all these uncials in front of him, arbitrarily taking 9 readings from P^{72} , 2 from P^{100} , 40 from $\aleph$, etc., etc., etc.? Really now, how shall we account for these 119 early readings in $\mathbf{f}^{35}$? (Should anyone demur that the 5th century MSS included really are not all that early, I inquire: are they copies, or original creations? If they are copies their exemplars were obviously earlier—all of these 119 readings doubtless existed in the 3rd century.)

Going on to the next block, we have another 148 readings where there is no pattern or dependency; $119 + 148 = 267 = 34\%$. Really now, how shall we account for these 267 early readings in $\mathbf{f}^{35}$? Going on to the next block, we have another 224 readings where there is no pattern or dependency; $267 + 224 = 491 = 61.8\%$. Really now, how shall we account for these 491 early readings in $\mathbf{f}^{35}$? Going on to the next block, we have another 100 readings where there is no pattern or dependency; $491 + 100 = 591 = 74.3\%$. The final block brings the total to 77.9%.

To allege a dependency in the face of this EVIDENCE I consider to be dishonest. $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ is clearly independent of all these lines of transmission, themselves independent. If $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ is independent then it is early, of necessity. $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ has all those early readings for the sufficient reason that its text is early, dating to the 3rd century, at least. But if $\mathbf{f}^{35}$ is independent of all other lines of